GGG-G-670

April 19, 1956

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. GGG-G-00670 (NAVY-SHIPS)
February 28, 1955 and
Fed. Spec. GGG-H-608
October 6, 1944

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

GRASS HOOKS, WHIP GRASS CUTTERS, AND WHIP WEED CUTTERS

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope.—This specification covers grass hooks, whip grass cutters, and whip weed cutters which are normally used for cutting, trimming, or slashing grasses and weeds.

1.1.1 *Federal specification coverage.*—Federal specifications do not include all types, classes, and styles of the commodities indicated by the titles of the specifications, or which are commercially available, but are intended to include only those most generally used by the Federal Government.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types, classes, and styles.*—Grass hooks, grass cutters, and weed cutters covered by this specification shall be of the following types, classes, and styles, as specified (see 6.1 and 6.2):

Type I.—Scythe-type grass hook.
  Class 1.—Heavy duty.
    Style A.—Long-handled.
    Style B.—Short-handled.
  Class 2.—Medium duty.
    Style A.—Long-handled.
    Style B.—Short-handled.
Type II.—Sickle-type grass hook.
  Class 1.—Heavy duty.
  Class 2.—Medium duty.
Type III.—Whip grass cutter.
  Class 1.—Serrated edge.
  Class 2.—Plain edge.
Type IV.—Whip weed cutter.
  Class 1.—Serrated edge.
  Class 2.—Plain edge.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS.

2.1 Specifications and standards.—The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

NN-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated (for Domestic Shipment).

NN-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.

NN-H-81—Handles, Ash, for Tools.

NN-H-93—Handles, Hickory, Striking-Tool.

LLL-B-631—Boxes; Fiber, Corrugated (for Domestic Shipment).

LLL-B-636—Boxes; Fiber, Solid (for Domestic Shipment).

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PPP-B-585—Boxes; Wood, Wirebound.

PPP-B-601—Boxes; Wood, Cleated-Plywood.

Military Specifications:

JAN-P-103—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes; Wood Cleated; Solid Fiberboard.

JAN-P-106—Packaging and Packing for Overseas Shipment—Boxes; Wood, Nailed.

MIL-B-107—Boxes: Wood, Wirebound (Overseas Type).

JAN-P-108—Boxes, Fiberboard, Corrugated and Solid (Military Type).

MIL-P-116—Preservation, Methods of.

MIL-L-10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(*Activites outside the Federal Government may* obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is *for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent* of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications and Standards and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 **Other publications.** — The following publication, of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids, unless otherwise stated, forms a part of this specification:

Nongovernmental:

Consolidated Classification Committee Publication:

Consolidated Freight Classification Rules and Container Specifications.

(Application for copies of Consolidated Freight Classification Rules and Container Specifications should be addressed to the Consolidated Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Ill.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 *Illustrations.*—The illustrations shown herein are for the convenience of identification and are not intended to preclude the purchase of grass hooks, grass cutters, and weed cutters which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this specification.

3.2 **Material.**—Materials used in the construction of grass hooks, grass cutters, and weed cutters shall be as specified hereinafter. All materials shall be of uniform quality and free of injurious defects. Strength and other physical properties shall be adequate throughout for the purpose intended (see 1.1).

3.3 **Finish.**—The finish shall be as specified herein for each particular part and shall reflect workmanship consistent with the functional requirements of the grass hook, grass cutter, and weed cutter.

3.4 **Coating.**—The coating shall be as specified herein for each individual part. The coating shall be properly applied and shall be completely dry.

3.5 **Identification marking.**—Each grass hook, grass cutter, and weed cutter shall be stamped or otherwise permanently marked in a plain and legible manner with the manufacturer's name or with a trade-mark of such

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known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.6 Blades.—The blade shall be made of 0.65 to 0.85 carbon steel heat-treated to possess a hardness of not less than 45 nor more than 55 on the Rockwell C scale when tested in accordance with 4.4.1. The surface finish shall be either a ground, polished, or a natural forged finish. Cutting edges shall be ground to a keen edge and be ready for immediate use. Surfaces, with the exception of the ground cutting edge(s), shall be protected with a durable coating of paint, varnish, enamel, or lacquer. Ground cutting edges shall be protected with a clear, durable coating of varnish or lacquer.

3.7 Wooden handles.—For the intents and purposes of this specification, long handles shall be defined as those handles whose over-all length exceeds 10 inches and short handles shall be defined as those handles whose over-all length is 10 inches or less. Long handles shall be made of grade SB white ash or grade A hickory of Federal Specifications NN-H-81 and NN-H-93, respectively. The maximum permissible cross-grain of long hickory handles shall conform to that permitted for grade SB ash handles as specified in Federal Specification NN-H-81. Short handles shall be made of clear, sound, straight-grained sugar maple, hickory, white ash, beech, or yellow birch. The maximum permissible cross-grain shall be 1 inch in 20 inches. The moisture content for all handles shall be in accordance with Federal Specification NN-H-81. Handle surfaces shall have a smooth finish as produced by sanding belt operation. The entire surface of long handles shall be completely covered with a clear, durable coating of lacquer or varnish. Long handles may be color-stained or otherwise colored by the manufacturer provided that such coloring does not conceal the annual rings and the grain of the wood, and does not discolor the user's hands. Exposed surfaces of short handles shall be protected with a durable coating of paint, enamel, varnish, or lacquer.

3.8 Shank, tang, and braces.—The shank, tang, and braces, as applicable, shall be of material as specified herein for the type and class, and shall be free from imperfections such as cracks, burrs, distortion, and any other imperfection that may adversely affect the serviceability or durability of the finished product. The finish shall be smooth such as produced by machining, stamping, or other manufacturing processes. Exposed surfaces shall be protected with a durable coating of paint, enamel, varnish, or lacquer.

3.9 Hardware.—The exposed surfaces of hardware such as rivets, bolts, nuts, and ferrules shall be protected with a durable coating of paint, varnish, enamel or lacquer.

3.10 Type I, scythe-type grass hook.—The type I grass hook shall conform to table I and shall consist essentially of a blade, shank, ferrule, and a handle or handgrip. Scythe-type grass hooks designed for right-hand use shall be furnished.

3.10.1 *Blade.*—The back edge of the blade shall be reinforced by upsetting or flanging and shall have one or more beads extending through approximately two-thirds of the blade length located just inside of and parallel to the back edge. The blade may or may not have cross-sectional taper. The cutting edge shall have a smooth, moderate curvature and shall be uniformly bevel ground to a keen edge throughout its entire length except for the portion under the shank. The heel end shall be provided with not less than two holes for attachment to the shank. The blade shall be securely fastened to the shank by means of two or more nuts and bolts or screws and shall be readily detachable for sharpening or replacement.

3.10.2 *Shank.*—The shank shall be of forged or stamped carbon steel, or of cast malleable iron. If stamped, the shank shall be ribbed longitudinally for strength. The blade end shall have a formed flat with not less than two holes properly aligned with the holes in the blade, for fastening securely to the blade.

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Table I.—*Type I, scythe-type grass hooks*

Class	Style	Overall Length A		Length of blade B		Thickness of blade C	Width of blade D		Widest portion of the handle E	
		Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
		Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inch*	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*
1 ..	A	43½	50	12	13	0.070	1⅞	2¼	1 1/16	1 3/16
1 ..	B	16¾	17¼	12	13	.070	1⅞	2¼	1¼	1⅜
2 ..	A	43½	50	11	13	.055	1⅞	2¼	1 1/16	1¼
2 ..	B	16	17¼	11	13	.055	1⅞	2¼	1¼	1⅜

3.10.3 *Ferrules.*—When used, ferrules shall be made of steel or other suitable metal and shall be of such design that when attached, the ferrule shall prevent the handle from splitting in the area of the tang.

3.10.4 *Class 1, heavy duty.*—The blade thickness of class 1 grass hooks shall be as specified in table I, as applicable.

3.10.4.1 *Style A, long-handled.*

3.10.4.1.1 *Shank.*—The shank shall be bent in such a manner as to offset the handle and provide not less than 15 inches of clearance when measured in accordance with 4.2.1.1.2. The shank shall be either plain for insertion into the handle or shall have a socket forged integral with the shank for attachment to the handle. If plain, the shank shall extend not less than 2 inches into the handle and shall be securely and permanently attached thereto by means of a ferrule and a through rivet. If an integral socket, the handle shall be driven to a firm seat and secured thereto with at least one through rivet, securely driven and neatly headed.

3.10.4.1.2 *Handle.* — The cross-sectional shape of the handle shall be round and the butt end shall be neatly rounded and smoothly finished.

3.10.4.1.3 *Style A grass hooks shall be similar to figure 1.*

3.10.4.2 *Style B, short-handled.*

3.10.4.2.1 *Shank.*—The shank shall be bent in such a manner so as to offset the handle and provide knuckle clearance of not less than 1⅜ inches when measured in accordance with 4.2.1.1.1. The shank shall extend not less than 2 inches into the handgrip and shall be securely and permanently attached thereto by means of either a metal ferrule and a neatly headed through rivet or, if no ferrule is employed, there shall be not less than two rivets, neatly headed and virtually flush with the handgrip surface, extending through the handgrip and shank.

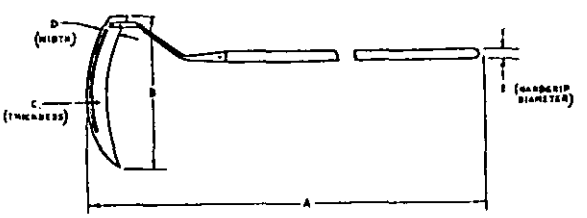


FIGURE 1.—*Type I, classes 1 and 2, style A, scythe-type grass hook, heavy and medium duty, long-handled.*

3.10.4.2.2 *Handle.* — The cross-sectional shape of the handle shall be round or oval. The surface shall be shaped so as to provide a safe, comfortable handhold and may be either plain or grooved.

3.10.4.2.3 *Style B grass hooks shall be similar to figure 2.*

3.10.5 *Class 2, medium duty.*—The blade thickness of class 2 grass hooks shall be as specified in table I, as applicable.

3.10.5.1 *Style A, long-handled.*—Style A grass hooks shall conform to 3.10.4.1 to 3.10.4.1.3, inclusive.

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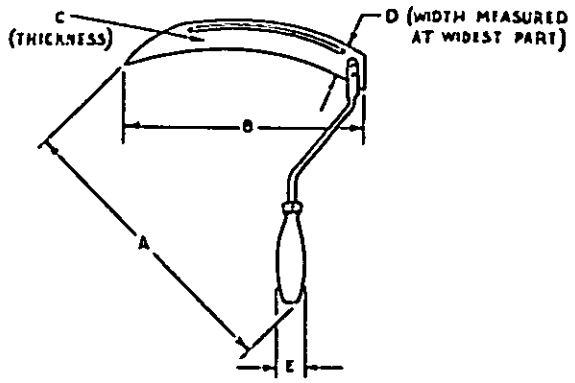


FIGURE 2.—*Type I, classes 1 and 2, style B, scythe-type grass hook, heavy and medium duty, short-handled.*

3.10.5.2 *Style B, short-handled.*—Style B grass hooks shall conform to 3.10.4.2 to 3.10.4.2.3, inclusive.

3.11 Type II, sickle-type grass hooks.—The type II grass hooks shall consist essentially of a blade with an integral tang, a handgrip, and rivets. Hooks designed for right-hand use shall be furnished.

3.11.1 *Blade and tang.*—The blade and tang shall be integral and shall be forged from a single piece of steel. The blade shall be shaped to form a hook of a smooth, moderate curvature. The point of the hook shall be formed by tapering either one or both edges so as to form a sharp, well-defined point. The tapered portion shall extend not more than 3½ inches when measured from the point. The width of the blade from the point to the tang shall be constant within 1/16 of an inch with the exception of the tapered portion. The cross-sectional shape shall be either rectangular, V-shaped, or a V-shape modified with continuous depressions near to and parallel with the back edge. The cutting edge shall be uniformly bevel ground throughout the entire length of the blade, except for a portion immediately adjacent to the tang. This unground portion shall not exceed 1½ inches when measured from the beginning of the radius of the bend forming the tang. The tang end of the blade shall be bent in such a manner as to offset the handle to provide not less than ¾ inch of knuckle clearance when measured in accordance with 4.2.1.1.1. There shall be not less than two holes located along the center line of the tang for attachment to the handle. The tang shall extend a minimum of 2¼ inches into the handgrip and shall be securely riveted thereto with not less than two neatly headed steel rivets, the heads of which shall be either flush with or recessed into the handle surface.

3.11.2 *Handle.*—The cross-sectional shape shall be either round, oval, or rectangular. The over-all shape shall be such as to produce a safe, comfortable handgrip. Sharp edges shall be neatly and smoothly rounded or beveled. There shall be not less than two holes located along the center line for attachment to the tang. The holes shall be of corresponding size to the rivets used. When assembled, there shall be no perceptible movement in any direction between the handle and the tang.

3.11.3 *Type II grass hooks shall be similar to figure 3.*

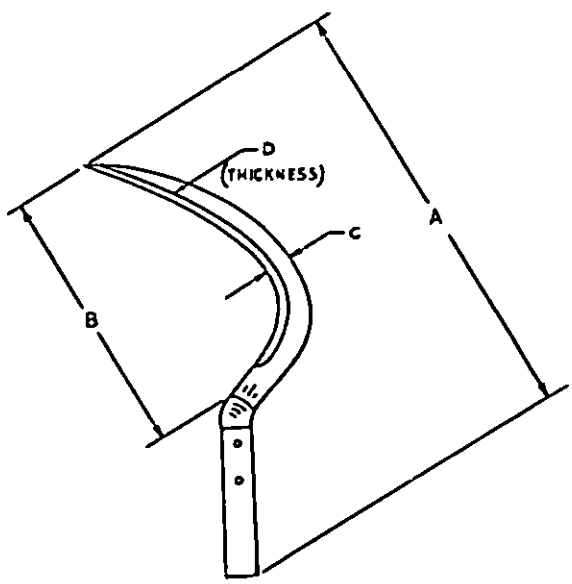


FIGURE 3.—*Type II, sickle-type grass hook.*

3.11.4 *Class 1, heavy duty.*—Class 1 grass hooks shall conform to table II, as applicable.

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TABLE II.—*Type II, sickle type grass hook*

Class	Overall length A		Length of blade B		Width of blade C		Thickness of blade D[1]	
	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.	Min.	Max.
	Inches	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inches*	*Inch*	*Inches*	*Inch*	*Inch*
1	18	19¼	12⅜	13¼	1⅜₁₆	1¼	0.095	0.150
2	15½	17¾	10½	12¼	1⅜₁₆	1¼	.073	.094

[1]These dimensions shall be for blades showing flat cross section. Blades having a tapered or V-shaped cross section shall be considered as thick as 65 percent of the largest portion for comparative purposes and use of this table.

3.12 *Type III, whip grass cutter.*—The type III grass cutter shall be a lightweight, flexible tool consisting essentially of a blade, a shank, and a handle and shall conform to the dimensions shown on figure 4. The design shall be such that it can be held and swung in a manner similar to that of a golf club and will cut on both the forward and return stroke.

3.12.1 *Blade.*—The general shape of the blade shall be rectangular and flat throughout the longitudinal cross section. The lateral cross section shall show either a flat or slightly curved shape. There shall be two cutting edges formed on the opposing long sides of the blade and shall be either straight or slightly concave. Blades having flat lateral cross sections shall be bevel ground so as to produce a keep cutting edge. Blades having a curved lateral cross section shall be sharpened by grinding the ends of the ellipse flat in the same horizontal plane. The bevel which forms the cutting edge shall be not less than ¼ inch wide. The heel of the blade may or may not have an integral tang. The tang shall be bent upwards in such manner that the center line of the tang and the center line of the blade lie in the same vertical plane and the angle formed thereby shall form an acute angle inclined towards the toe of the blade. The tang shall have not less than two holes located along the center line for attaching to the shank. Blades having no tang shall be provided with not less than two holes located along the center line for attaching to the shank. The holes in the tang or blade shall be in alignment with the holes in the shank. The blade shall be securely bolted to the shank with not less than two nuts and bolts and shall be readily detachable for sharpening or replacement.

3.12.2 *Shank.*—The shank shall be of carbon steel and either square, round, or oval in cross section. There shall be a formed flat on the blade end for attachment to the blade or tang. There shall be not less than two holes in the formed flat located along the center line, in alignment with the holes in the blade or tang, and shall be of corresponding size to the attaching hardware. The blade end of the shank shall be bent in such manner that when the tool is assembled, the longitudinal axis of the handle will be at an angle of approximately 60 degrees to the longitudinal axis of the blade, and a line drawn through the longitudinal axis of the handle shall bisect the blade at its approximate longitudinal center. The shank shall extend into the handle and be securely and permanently attached thereto by means of a metal ferrule and a neatly headed rivet extending through the ferrule, handle and shank.

3.12.3 *Handle.*—The handle shall be made from ash or hickory wood and shall be round or oval in cross section. The surface of the handle shall be shaped so as to provide a safe, comfortable, handhold and the sides may be

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flattened slightly to insure a more positive grip. The butt end of the handle shall be neatly rounded and smoothly finished.

3.12.4 *Ferrules.*—Ferrules shall be made of steel or other suitable metal and shall be of such design that when attached, the ferrule shall prevent the handle from splitting in the shank areas.

3.12.5 *Class 1, serrated edge.*—Class 1 grass cutters shall be similar in design to figure 4.

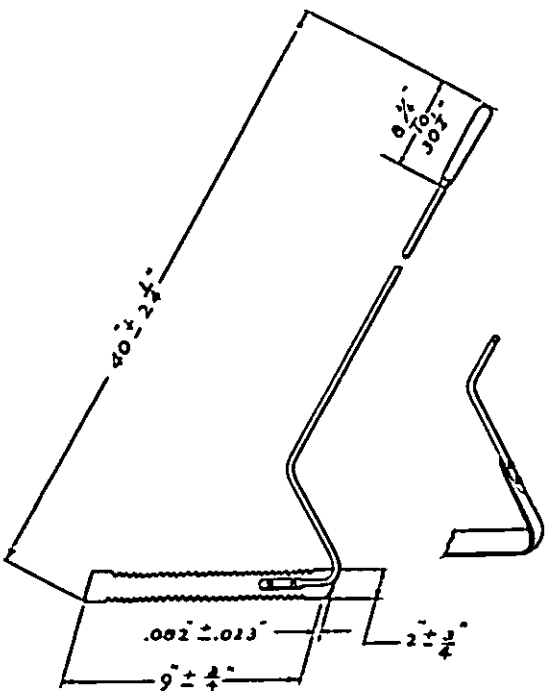


FIGURE 4.—*Type III, grass cutter.*

3.12.5.1 *Blade.*—The cutting edges shall be serrated to within ⅝ inch or less of each end of the blade.

3.12.6 *Class 2, plain edge.*—Class 2 grass cutters shall be similar in design to figure 4, except the cutting edges shall be plain throughout the entire blade length.

3.13 *Type IV, whip weed cutter.*—Type IV weed cutter shall be sturdily constructed and shall consist essentially of a blade joined to a wooden handle by means of braces forming a yoke for extra rigidity. The design shall be such that it can be held and swung in a manner similar to that of the golf club and will cut on both the forward and return stroke.

3.13.1 *Blade.*—The general shape of the blade shall be rectangular and shall be flat throughout the lateral and longitudinal cross sections. The blade shall have two cutting edges formed on the opposing long sides and be either straight or slightly concave. The cutting edges shall be bevel ground so as to produce a keen cutting edge. The width of the bevel forming the cutting edge shall be not less than ¼ inch. Two holes shall be provided in the blade, one at either end, located along the center line for attaching to the braces. The blade shall be attached to the braces by means of nuts and bolts or neatly headed rivets.

3.13.2 *Braces.*—The braces shall be formed of carbon steel, channeled or ribbed longitudinally. The end which joins the blade shall be flattened and bent under and be provided with a hole located along the center line for attaching to the blade. The other end of the brace shall be formed to fit the contour of its mating handle surface and shall have not less than two holes for attaching to the handle. The holes in the braces shall be of corresponding size to the attaching hardware. The braces shall be of differing lengths and bent in such a manner that when the tool is assembled the longitudinal axis of the handle will be at an angle of approximately 60 degrees to the longitudinal axis of the blade and a line drawn through the longitudinal axis of the handle shall bisect the blade at its approximate longitudinal center. The braces shall have a smooth curvature so as to produce clearance between the blade and the brace. This clearance, measured perpendicular to the blade at its center, shall be equal to at least one-half the distance between the brace mounting holes in the blade. The braces shall be securely fastened to the handle by means of nuts and bolts or neatly headed rivets.

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3.13.3 *Handle.*—The handle shall be made of ash or hickory wood. The cross-sectional shape shall be either round or oval and shall produce a safe, comfortable handhold. The butt end of the handle shall be slightly flared to prevent slippage of the user's hands. The shank end of the handle shall be provided with not less than two holes in alignment with the holes in the braces for attachment thereto.

3.13.4 *Class 1, serrated edge.*—Class 1 weed cutters shall conform to the dimensions shown on figure 5.

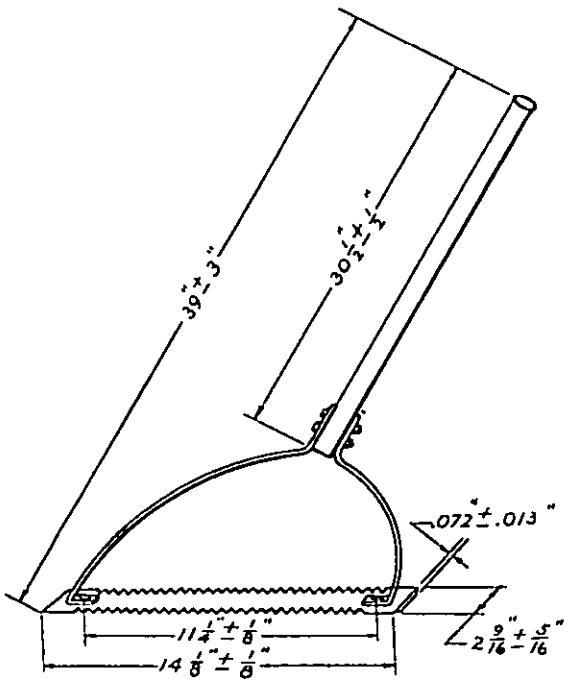


FIGURE 5.—*Type IV, weed cutter.*

3.13.4.1 *Blade.*—The cutting edge shall be serrated throughout the center portion. The serrations shall approach the toe end to within 1⅛ inch or less, and the heel end to within 1 inch or less.

3.13.5 *Class 2, plain edge.*—Class 2 weed cutters shall conform to the dimensions shown on figure 5.

3.13.5.1 *Blade.*—The cutting edges shall be plain throughout the entire blade length.

3.14 *Workmanship.*—Workmanship shall be of the highest grade throughout and equal in every respect to good commercial practice. The blades of grass hooks, grass cutters, and weed cutters shall be free from any imperfections including scale, seams, laps, cracks, burrs, nicks, chips, warpage or distortion of any kind, and any other imperfections that may adversely affect their durability or serviceability. The wooden handles shall be free of cracks, nicks, and any other splinter-producing imperfections.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Sampling for lot acceptance.

4.1.1 *Inspection lot.*—All hooks or cutters of the same style, class and type presented at one time shall be considered a lot for purposes of acceptance inspection and tests.

4.1.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection.*

4.1.2.1 *Sampling for intermittent procurement in isolated lots.*—A random sample of hooks or cutters shall be taken by the Government inspector from each inspection lot of material offered for Government inspection of visual and dimensional characteristics with lot acceptance based on the sampling inspection requirements of table III in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

TABLE III.—*Sampling for visual and dimensional inspection AQL (approx.) = 1.5 percent defective*

Number of hooks or cutters in inspection lot	Number of hooks or cutters in sample	Acceptance number (defectives)	Rejection number (defectives)
15 and under	7	0	1
16 to 40	10	0	1
41 to 110 ...	15	0	1
111 to 300 ...	25	1	2
301 to 500 ...	35	1	2
501 to 800 ...	50	2	3
801 to 1300 ..	75	3	4
1301 and over .	110	4	5

NOTE.—The Government inspector may institute tightened or reduced inspection in accordance with section 9 of Military Standard MIL-STD-105.

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4.1.2.2 *Sampling for continuous production.*—Where there is continuous production for the Government and inspection lots include at least 200 items, sampling for Government inspection shall be conducted in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-105 at inspection level I and A.Q.L.=1.5 percent defective; the type of sampling (single, double or multiple) shall be determined by the Government inspector.

4.1.3 *Sampling for lot acceptance tests.*—A random sample of hooks or cutters shall be taken by the Government inspector from each inspection lot in accordance with table IV and shall be subjected to the tests specified in 4.4.

TABLE IV.—*Sampling for lot acceptance tests*

Number of hooks or cutters in inspection lot	Number of hooks or cutters in sample	Number of items nonconforming on any lot acceptance test	
		Acceptance number	Rejection number
15 and under .	3	0	1
16 to 40	5	0	1
41 to 110	7	0	1
111 to 300	10	0	1
301 to 500	15	1	2
501 to 800	25	2	3
801 and over ..	35	3	4

4.2 Inspection.

4.2.1 *Visual and dimensional inspection.*—Each of the sample hooks or cutters taken in accordance with table III shall be visually and dimensionally inspected for compliance with respect to material, workmanship, design, dimensions, finish, marking and other requirements of this specification which may be determined by visual examination, and in particular the requirements of 4.2.1.1 through 4.2.2.

4.2.1.1 *Handle clearance.*

4.2.1.1.1 *Short-handled grass hooks.*—The knuckle clearance shall be determined by resting the blade of an assembled tool flat on a plane surface and measuring the distance between the under side of the handle and the plane surface at the shank end of the handle (see 3.10.4.2.1 and 3.11.1).

4.2.1.1.2 *Long-handled grass hooks.*—The handle clearance shall be determined by resting the blade of an assembled tool flat on a plane surface and measuring the distance between the plane surface and the under side of the handle at a point along the handle approximately 30 inches from the back edge of the blade measured along the axis of the blade (see 3.10.4.1.1).

4.2.2 Any hook or cutter in the sample containing one or more visual or dimensional defects shall be rejected, and if the number of defective hooks or cutters in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.3 Lot acceptance tests.

4.3.1 *Testing for lot acceptance.*—Each of the sample hooks or cutters taken in accordance with table IV shall be tested in accordance with 4.4 to verify compliance with this specification. Any sample hook or cutter which does not meet the requirements for any of these characteristics shall be rejected, and if the number of nonconforming hooks or cutters in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4 Test procedures.

4.4.1 *Blade hardness test.*—The hardness shall be determined using a Rockwell tester with a diamond penetrator and employing a 150 kilogram major load. Not less than three determinations shall be made on each test sample. The determinations for plain-edged blades shall be taken approximately ⅛ inch back from the beveled portion which forms the cutting edge. The determinations for serrated blades shall be taken at any point on the blade suitable for operation of the tester. Each determination shall be not less than that specified in 3.6.

4.4.2 *Shank, tang, or brace strength.*

4.4.2.1 *Type I, scythe-type grass hook.*

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4.4.2.1.1. *Classes 1 and 2, style A, heavy and medium duty, long-handled.*—The handle shall be securely clamped at the ferrule in such a manner that the axis of the blade lies in a vertical position with the point in an upward position. A 25-pound weight shall be attached at the point of juncture of the shank and blade as shown on figure 6. The weight shall be allowed to hang unobstructed for a period of not less than 30 seconds. Shank failure shall be considered to have occurred when the permanent set exceeds ⅛ inch at the point of load application after removal of the test load.

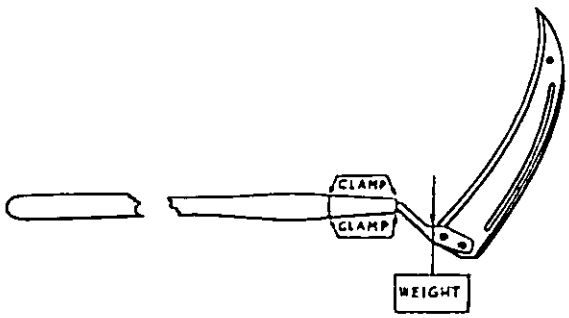


FIGURE 6.—*Shank test for type I, classes 1 and 2, style A, scythe-type grass hook, heavy and medium duty, long-handled.*

4.4.2.1.2 *Classes 1 and 2, style B, heavy and medium duty, short-handled.*—The blade shall be rested flat on a horizontal surface in a normal working position. The blade shall be securely clamped to this surface by C clamps, or similar devices, and at least one clamp shall be immediately adjacent to the point where the shank joins the blade. The entire shank and handle shall extend over the edge of the surface. A 6-pound weight shall be attached to the handle at the center of the handgrip as shown on figure 7. The weight shall be allowed to hang unobstructed for a period of not less than 30 seconds. Shank failure shall be considered to have occurred when the permanent set exceeds ⅛ inch at the point of load application after removal of the test load.

4.4.2.2 *Type II, sickle-type grass hook.*—The test shall be conducted in accordance

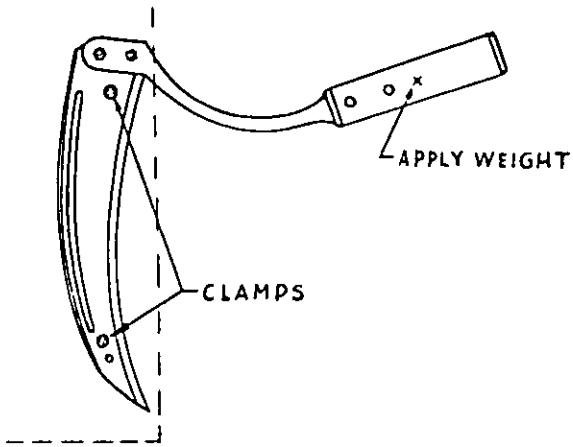


FIGURE 7.—*Shank test for type I, classes 1 and 2, style B, scythe-type grass hook, heavy and medium duty, short-handled.*

with 4.4.2.1, except that a 15-pound weight shall be employed as shown on figure 8.

4.4.2.3 *Type III, grass cutter.*—The handle shall be securely clamped at the ferrule in such a manner that the handle lies in a horizontal position with the toe of the blade as the point of highest elevation. A test load of 210 inch-pounds shall be applied at the lowest point of the shank as shown on figure 9. The load shall be applied for a period of not less than 30 seconds. Shank failure shall be considered to have occurred if the permanent set exceeds ⅛ inch, at the point of load application, after removal of the test load.

4.4.2.4 *Type IV, weed cutter.*—The handle shall be securely clamped in the area of brace and handle juncture, in such a manner that

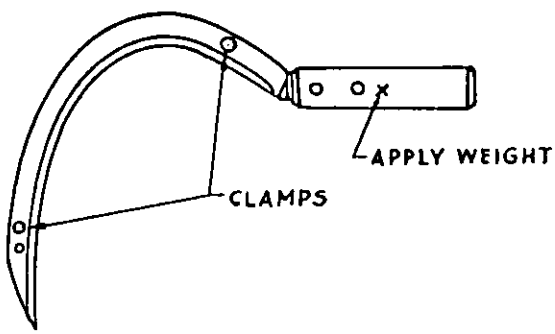


FIGURE 8.—*Shank test for type II, classes 1 and 2, sickle-type grass hook, heavy and medium duty.*

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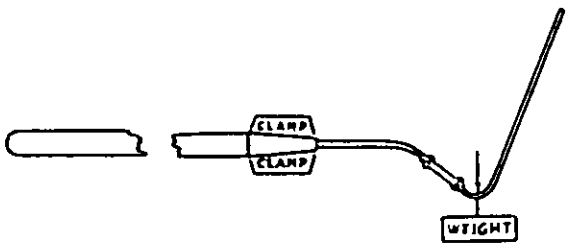


FIGURE 9.—*Shank test for type III, classes 1 and 2, grass cutter, serrated and plain edge.*

the axis of the handle and the axis of the blade lie in a horizontal plane. A 50-pound weight shall be attached to the blade in its center as shown on figure 10, and shall be allowed to hang unobstructed for a period of not less than 30 seconds, after which the weight shall be removed. The clamp holding the handle shall be loosened and the tool rotated clockwise 90° and refastened. The weight shall be suspended from the point where the lower brace joins the blade for a period of not less than 30 seconds. The test shall be similarly conducted in the two remaining quadrants. After each individual quadrant is tested, the braces shall be inspected for permanent set. Brace failure shall be considered to have occurred when the permanent set exceeds ⅛ inch after the removal of the test load.

4.5 *Rejected lots.*—Rejected lots may be offered again for Government inspection provided the contractor has repaired or removed all non-conforming hooks or cutters. The Government inspector shall again select and examine samples from such resubmitted lots to verify compliance with this specification.

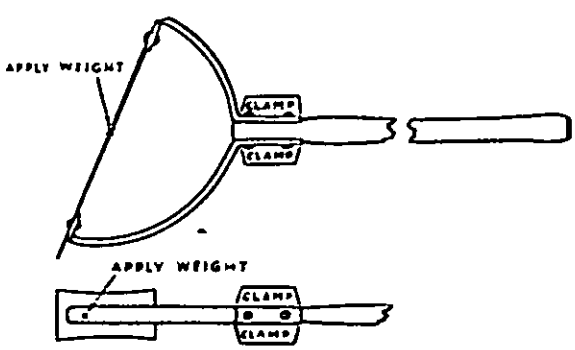


FIGURE 10.—*Shank test for type IV, classes 1 and 2, weed cutter, serrated and plain edge.*

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Nonmilitary requirements.

5.1.1 *Preservation.*—Cleaning and preservation shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's standard practice.

5.1.2 *Packaging.*—Commercial packages will be acceptable.

5.1.3 *Packing.*—The equipment shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose in such manner as to insure acceptance and safe delivery to the designated point by common or other carrier at the lowest rate of the carrier.

5.1.4 *Marking.*

5.1.4.1 *Interior containers.*—Packages and interior containers shall be marked with the name of the material and the name of the contractor or trade-mark of such known character that the source of supply may be readily determined.

5.1.4.2 *Exterior containers.*—Shipping containers shall be marked with the name of the item, the type, class, style (if applicable), and the quantity therein, as defined by the contract or order under which shipment is made, the name of the contractor, and the number of the contract or order.

5.2 Military requirements.

5.2.1 *Packaging.*

5.2.1.1 *Domestic shipment—immediate use.*—Packaging shall be in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2.1.2 *Domestic shipment and storage or overseas shipment.*—Hooks and cutters shall be unit protected in accordance with method III of Military Specification MIL-P-116.

5.2.2 *Packing.*

5.2.2.1 *Domestic shipment — immediate use.* The hooks and cutters packaged as specified in 5.2.1.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination. Containers shall be in accordance with the Consolidated Freight Classification Rules or regulations of other carriers

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as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.2.2.2 *Domestic shipment and storage.*—The hooks and cutters, packaged as specified in 5.2.1.2, shall be packed in wood cleated-fiberboard, nailed wood, wirebound, corrugated or solid fiberboard or wood cleated-plywood boxes conforming to Federal Specification NN-B-591, NN-B-621, PPP-B-585, LLL-B-631, LLL-B-636, or PPP-B-60 (domestic type), respectively. The gross weight of wood boxes and wood cleated-fiberboard boxes shall not exceed 200 pounds; of fiberboard boxes 90 pounds.

5.2.2.3 *Overseas shipment.*—Unless otherwise specified, hooks and cutters packaged as specified in 5.2.1.2 shall be packed in wood-cleated solid fiberboard, nailed wood, cleated-plywood, wirebound wood or fiberboard boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP-B-601 (overseas type), Military Specification JAN-P-103, JAN-P-106, MIL-B-107, or JAN-P-108, symbol V3s or V3c. Wood type shipping containers shall be provided with a sealed waterproof case liner conforming to Military Specification MIL-L-10547. The gross weight of wood and wood type shipping containers shall not exceed 200 pounds; of fiberboard boxes 70 pounds.

5.2.3 *Marking.*—In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and exterior shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 *Intended use.*—Grass hooks, grass cutters, and weed cutters covered by this specification are intended for use as follows:

(a) Type I scythe-type grass hook is normally used for cutting or slashing dense growths of grass or light weeds.

(b) Type II sickle-type grass hook is normally used for cutting small areas of tall grass.

(c) Type III grass cutter is normally used for trimming small tufts of grass and light weeds.

(d) Type IV weed cutter is used for cutting dense growths of weeds and grass.

6.2 Ordering data.—Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(b) Type, class, and style required (see 1.2).

(c) Whether preparation for domestic shipment immediate use, domestic shipment and storage, or overseas shipment is required (see section 5).

6.3 Transportation description.—The applicable transportation description is:

Types I and II:

Hooks, grass.

Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds.

Types III and IV:

Cutters, weed.

Carload minimum weight 24,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Truckload minimum weight 24,000 pounds.

Patent notice.—When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

MILITARY INTEREST:
Army—E
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Air Force.

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